

OPSC6311

PART 1, SECTION 1

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Introduction:

Budgeting applications have become important digital tools for people who want to manage their finances more effectively. These apps allow users to monitor their income, expenses, and savings, which helps them create structured budgets and set realistic financial goals. By providing insights into spending patterns, budget apps improve financial awareness and encourage more responsible money management. As a result, they help users achieve greater financial stability and have become valuable resources in the modern financial environment. This research will explore the role of budgeting applications and examine its strengths and weaknesses as well as its innovative features that help individuals manage their personal finances more efficiently (NectarMoney, 2025).

Overview:

GoodBudget Overview:

Goodbudget is a budget tracking app that uses a digital, envelope style design. The design helps with proactive planning, expense tracking, and household sharing across multiple devices (Google Play, 2026).

Goodbudget is targeted at individuals and households who want to transition from a traditional envelope budgeting method. It is popular amongst couples, families as well as those seeking to improve their financial habits through intentional planning rather than just tracking (Google Play, 2026)

Goodbudget's main features consist of dividing expenses into envelopes, transactions where you post a transaction you made, syncing accounts with other people and reports where you monitor your expenses to check which expense you're spending the most on weekly, monthly and yearly

How it works it. The user creates an envelope and enters how much money they intend to spend on that envelope for that month. So, their responsibility is to enter their transactions and say that the transaction they are making is part of that account and with every transaction, the amount entered initially decreases. If you spend more than the allocated amount, then that means you're not sticking to your budget

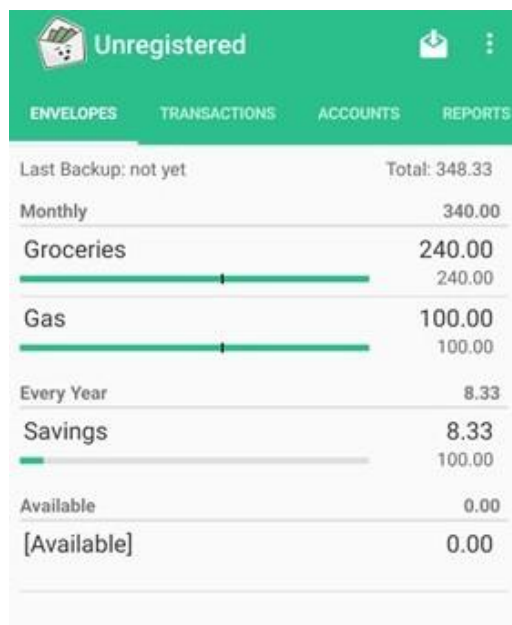


Figure 1.1 Show the Envelopes section of the application. Where users divide their money into their respective categories.

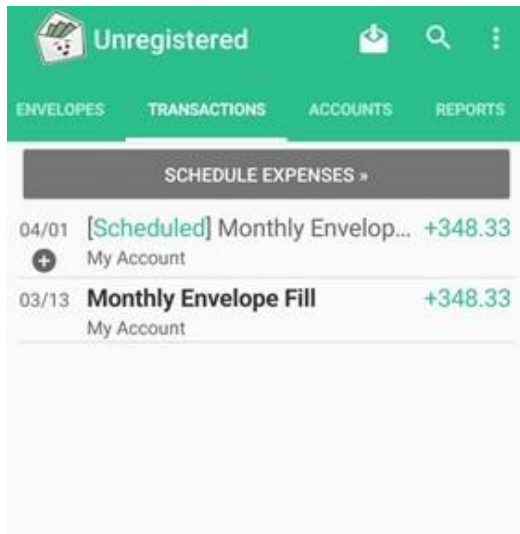


Figure 1.2 Shows the Transactions section. It's where the user manually enters every transaction to see how much money they have to spend.

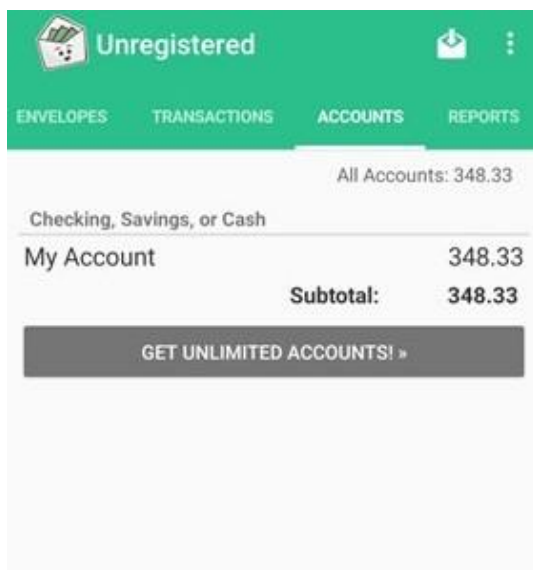


Figure 1.3 Shows the Accounts section where users enter how much money they get in total and as they purchase, this section shows users how much money is left overall.

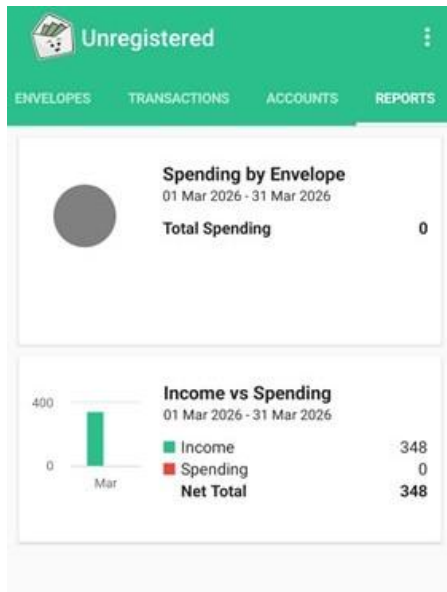


Figure 1.4 Shows the Reports section of the application. There is a monthly report so users can see how much money they spend in a specific month. Not just spendings but earnings.

Vault22 Overview:

Vault 22 is a budgeting application designed to help users manage their personal finances effectively. The app allows users to track their income and expenses, create budgets, and monitor their spending habits in one place. By providing a clear overview of financial activity, Vault 22 helps users make better financial decisions (Laudon and Laudon, 2020).

The application includes features such as expense categorization, budget planning, and financial goal setting. These features support users in controlling their spending and improving their saving habits. Budgeting apps like Vault 22 are important tools in personal finance management, as they promote financial awareness and discipline (O'Neill, 2021).

Overall, Vault 22 aims to simplify money management by offering an easy-to-use platform that supports users in achieving financial stability.

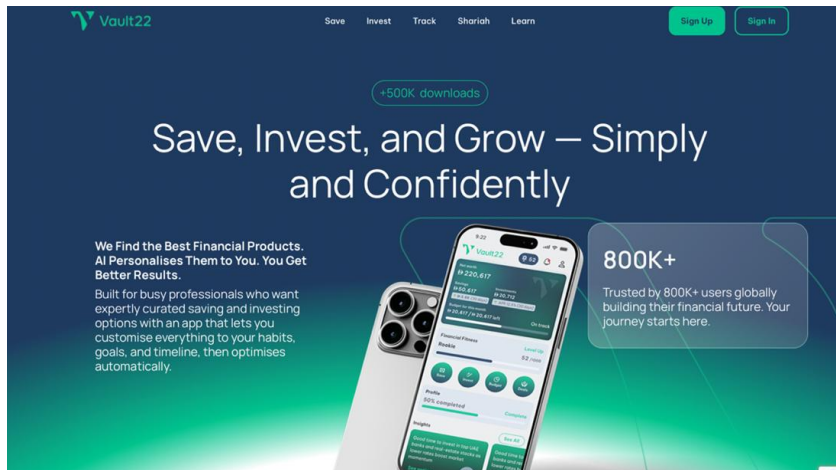


Figure 2.1 Shows the discovery page which is what users see as soon they click on the link in google search.

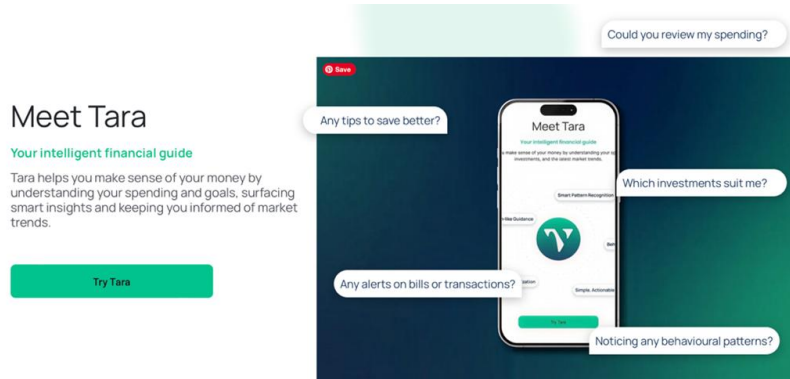


Figure 2.2 Shows Tara, the Ai chatbot that answers questions users might have.

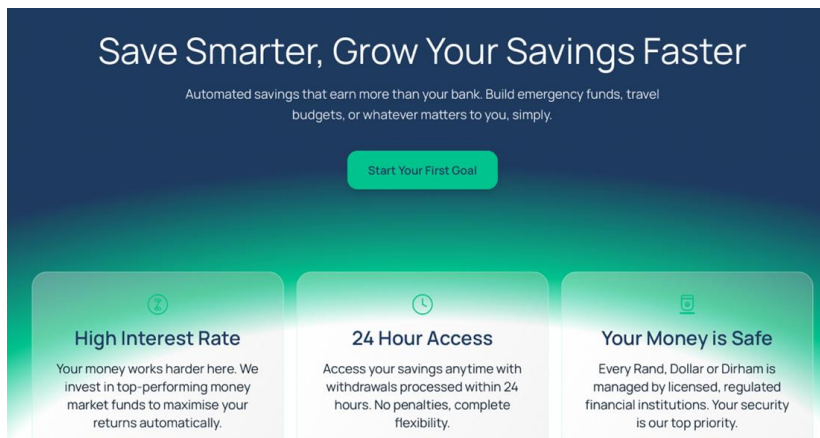


Figure 2.3 The save page is where users can start their journey of saving money.

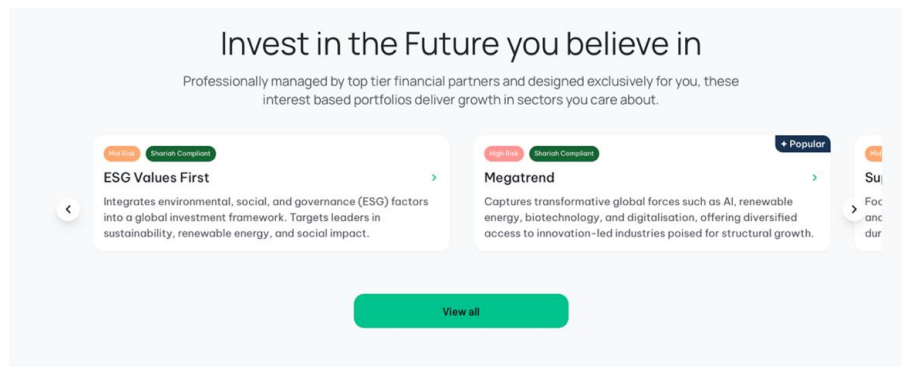


Figure 2.4 Shows the “Invest” page, which lists all available investments.

Spendee Overview:

Spendee uses collaborative budgeting tools and visual spending tracking to especially handle personal finance management. The program enables users to share budgets with partners or family, classify transactions manually or automatically, and establish unique wallets for various financial accounts. Its ability to display intricate financial data in clear graphs and charts that quickly highlight expenditure trends is one of its strongest points. Bitget (2026). Additionally, Spendee's user-friendly interface and customizable features make it an ideal choice for individuals and households seeking to streamline their financial planning and achieve their savings goals.

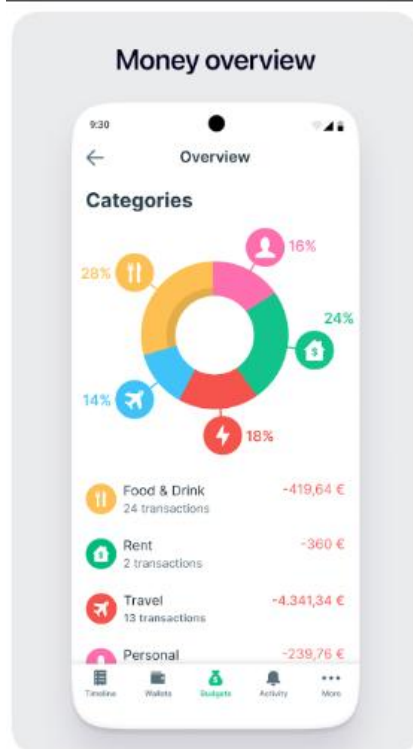


Figure 3.1 The figure represents a financial tracking dashboard that helps users quickly see where their money is going, using visual charts and category summaries.

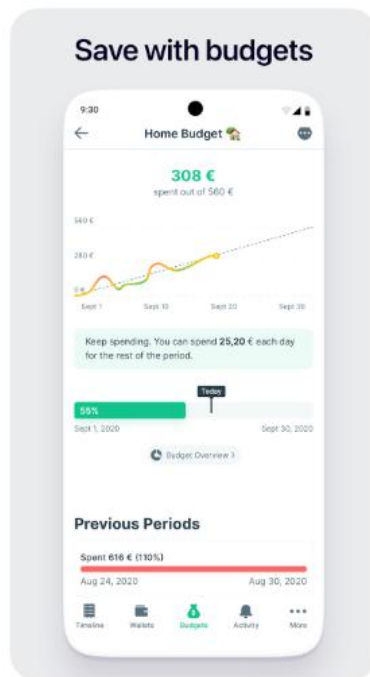


Figure 3.2 This image represents a budget monitoring screen that helps users track spending over time, receive guidance, and compare current performance with past budgets

Strengths and Weaknesses:

GoodBudget:

Strengths:

- Great for couples and families, as it allows multiple users to sync their accounts across devices (Experian, 2026).
- Strong free version, it's not automated but it's ideal for beginners (IdeaUsher, 2024).
- Provides spending reports that compare your income and expenses, so as a user you can spot patterns and adjust your budget (Experian, 2026).

Weaknesses:

- Manual transaction entry- the free version, though strong, requires you to manually enter transactions (CNBC, 2026).

- Lack of automation- even in the paid version, transactions are imported but require manual categorization, which is less automated than other budget apps (Experian, 2026).
- Transaction delays- even for premium users, bank feeds can sometimes take several days to update (IdeaUsher, 2024).

Vault22:

Strengths:

- Easy to navigate around the website
- Website loads quickly
- Discovery page is user friendly, and it grabs your attention
- Shows reviews from users
- Highlights on how popular and how risky each investment is.

Weaknesses:

- Users can't access much without signing in

Spendee:

Strengths:

- For couples or groups who share financial responsibility, this is a great way to manage joint spending and make life easier.
- Understanding spending trends is made much simpler and more inspiring by clear, eye-catching visuals.
- Support for many currencies is a big benefit for people who travel a lot or handle money across borders Portmoneo (2026)

Weaknesses:

- The program is more concerned with manual entry or bank import than it is with scanning receipts.
- There isn't much offline functionality.
- Premium features start at \$2.99 per month; the free tier is extremely limited Portmoneo (2026)

Innovative Features:

GoodBudget:

- Virtual Envelope System- Goodbudget forces users to allocate income into specific categories at the beginning of the month (hayes.cpa, 2025).
- Shared Household Budgeting- Goodbudget allows partners or families to sync and manage the same budget across multiple devices (IdeaUsher, 2024).
- Goal-based envelopes- Users on Goodbudget can create special envelopes for long term goals or debt reduction (IdeaUsher, 2024).

Vault 22:

- Has an Ai chatbot named Tara that answers questions the users might have.
- Articles to help customers learn more about their finances
- It consists of automated payments and reminders, to prevent late fees and overdrafts with security measures.

Spendee:

- Connect Spendee with all your bank accounts
- Automatic categorization of your bank account transactions
- Multiple wallets for specific events
- Unlimited budgeting
- Share wallets with others Spendee (n.d.)

Infographic Comparison:

VISUAL INFOGRAPHIC

	GoodBudget	Vault 22	Spendee
Features	Envelope budgeting system, ability to share budgets, synchronization across apps, and detailed reports	Automatic tracking of transactions, budgeting capabilities, investment monitoring, bill management, and calculation for net worth	Automatic categorization of transactions, budget management, shared financial features, and support for multiple currencies
Element Pricing	Free version available, Premium for \$8 per month	Completely free of charge	Free version available, \$280 per year, \$426 for premium per year
Platforms	Web, iOS, Android	Web, iOS, Android, Huawei	Web, iOS, Android
Security	Multi-factor authentication	Read-only access to bank accounts with bank-level encryption	Secure data storage and encryption at the bank level
Target Audience	Individuals, couples, and families that want hands-on budgeting	Everyone seeking a thorough financial picture	Couples, people, and families looking for an easy-to-use budgeting app

Best Features:

GoodBudget:

- Real-time bank syncing, with the Premium version, it would be a great feature if users purchased something, and that purchase be reflected immediately other than having to wait days or even weeks to see what kind of spending you've made.

Vault 22:

- AI chatbot feature so users can ask questions and receive assistance and view frequently asked questions to receive automated answers
- Investment features, where users can set investment goals

Spendee:

- A shared wallet, a feature that allows family members, friends and/or couples to have a joint account that allows them to withdraw, deposit, and transfer funds together.
- 7 days free-trial for users to use the free version before deciding to use the premium version of the app.

Conclusion:

In conclusion, Vault22, GoodBudget, and Spendee each provide unique features and advantages that address various budgeting requirements. Vault22 stands out with its automatic transaction tracking and investment options, whereas GoodBudget's envelope method and Spendee's user-friendliness contribute to their popularity. Ultimately, the ideal app varies based on personal preferences and financial objectives of the user, emphasizing the significance of evaluating features, costs, and user experience when choosing a budgeting application.

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